

Module 2: Migration Data and Global Trends

Service Learning Project

Local Migration Data Profile for a Community Partner

Overview

Build a plain-language migration data profile of your city or county for an organization that serves newcomers — and document who is missing from the official numbers.

Aligned learning outcomes

- Interpret migration datasets (UG 1)
- Identify trends relevant to the local community (UG 2)
- Recognize missing populations (UG 3)
- Explain data limitations to a non-technical audience (UG 4)

Suggested community partners

- Refugee resettlement agencies needing service-planning data
- School district ESL/newcomer program offices
- City or county offices of new Americans / immigrant affairs
- Food banks or health clinics serving immigrant neighborhoods

Project steps

1. Meet the partner to learn what data questions matter to their work (e.g., languages spoken, arrivals by year, school enrollment).
2. Gather data from public sources: American Community Survey, refugee arrival data, school and health department statistics, UN/IOM country profiles.
3. Interview partner staff about who they serve whom the data does not capture (undocumented residents, children, people with disabilities).
4. Draft the profile in plain language with 3–4 clear charts; include a 'who is missing from these numbers' section.
5. Review the draft with the partner for accuracy and usefulness; revise.
6. Present the final profile to partner staff.

Deliverables

- 4–6 page community data profile (partner keeps it)
- 'Data gaps' memo explaining limitations and missing populations
- Reflection (2 pages) on the politics of counting

Time commitment

15 hours (partner meetings, data work, presentation).

Ethics requirements

Use only aggregate public data; never collect or publish individual-level information about the partner's clients.

Grading rubric

Each criterion is scored at one of four levels, then weighted as shown. The overall grade is the weighted combination of criterion scores. Instructors may adapt weights and descriptors to local requirements.

Criterion (weight)	Exemplary (A)	Proficient (B)	Developing (C)	Beginning (D–F)
Accuracy of data work and sourcing 30%	Evidence and accuracy are exemplary: accuracy of data work and sourcing is met with high-quality, correctly cited sources for every substantive claim; terms, facts, and frameworks are used precisely.	Evidence and accuracy are solid: accuracy of data work and sourcing is met for nearly all claims, with only minor sourcing gaps or imprecisions that do not affect conclusions.	Evidence and accuracy are uneven: accuracy of data work and sourcing is partly met — some claims lack support, sources are thin or misread, or terms are used loosely in ways that weaken conclusions.	Evidence and accuracy are deficient: accuracy of data work and sourcing is not met; key claims are unsupported or wrong, and errors undermine the work's conclusions.
Honesty and clarity about data limitations 25%	Communication is publication-ready: honesty and clarity about data limitations is achieved with precise, well-organized prose, correct citation, and figures or formats that make the argument easier to grasp.	Communication is clear and professional: honesty and clarity about data limitations is achieved with minor lapses in polish, organization, or citation that never obscure meaning.	Communication is understandable but rough: honesty and clarity about data limitations is only partly achieved — disorganization, citation errors, or unclear figures make the reader work to follow the argument.	Communication impedes the work: honesty and clarity about data limitations is not achieved; errors, disorganization, or missing citations obscure the substance.
Usefulness to the partner, confirmed by partner feedback 25%	The deliverable is excellent: usefulness to the partner, confirmed by partner feedback is met at a standard the partner or audience can use immediately — complete, accurate, well-organized, and genuinely useful.	The deliverable is good: usefulness to the partner, confirmed by partner feedback is met; it is usable with minor revisions and its purpose is clearly served.	The deliverable is incomplete: usefulness to the partner, confirmed by partner feedback is only partly met — gaps, errors, or unclear organization mean substantial revision is needed before it could be used.	The deliverable is inadequate: usefulness to the partner, confirmed by partner feedback is not met; the product is unusable, inaccurate, or missing major required elements.

Criterion (weight)	Exemplary (A)	Proficient (B)	Developing (C)	Beginning (D–F)
Communication quality — plain language and charts 20%	Communication is publication-ready: communication quality — plain language and charts is achieved with precise, well-organized prose, correct citation, and figures or formats that make the argument easier to grasp.	Communication is clear and professional: communication quality — plain language and charts is achieved with minor lapses in polish, organization, or citation that never obscure meaning.	Communication is understandable but rough: communication quality — plain language and charts is only partly achieved — disorganization, citation errors, or unclear figures make the reader work to follow the argument.	Communication impedes the work: communication quality — plain language and charts is not achieved; errors, disorganization, or missing citations obscure the substance.